

ISHANK TANDON

INTERVIEW NINJA

SECRETS TO LANDING
YOUR DREAM JOB



INCLUDES
ANSWERS
TO THE 39
TOUGHEST
INTERVIEW
QUESTIONS

Interview Ninja

Secrets To Landing Your Dream Job

Ishank Tandon

Copyright © 2023 by Ishank Tandon

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form or by any means, including photocopying, recording, or other electronic or mechanical methods, without the prior written permission of the publisher, except in the case of brief questions embodied in critical reviews and certain other noncommercial uses permitted by copyright law. For permission requests, write to the publisher at the address below.

Disclaimer

The content provided in this book is designed to provide helpful information on the subjects discussed. This book is not meant to be used, nor should it be used, to diagnose or treat any medical condition. The numbers in this book are theoretical and are to be used for illustrative purposes only. The publisher and the author are not responsible for any actions you take or do not take as a result of reading this book, and are not liable for any damages or negative consequences from action or inaction to any person reading or following the information in this book. References are provided for informational purposes and do not constitute an endorsement of any websites or other sources. Readers should also be aware that the websites listed in this book may change or become obsolete.

Acknowledgement

Thank you, mom and dad. Your love and guidance have been a constant source of inspiration and motivation. I am forever grateful for the sacrifices you have made in raising me.

To my Grandparents. My Nana and Nani ji. You have believed in me more than anyone. There is no way I can repay you for how you have influenced me.

To my relatives who supported me through thick and thin. I call myself wealthy because of you.

Table of Contents

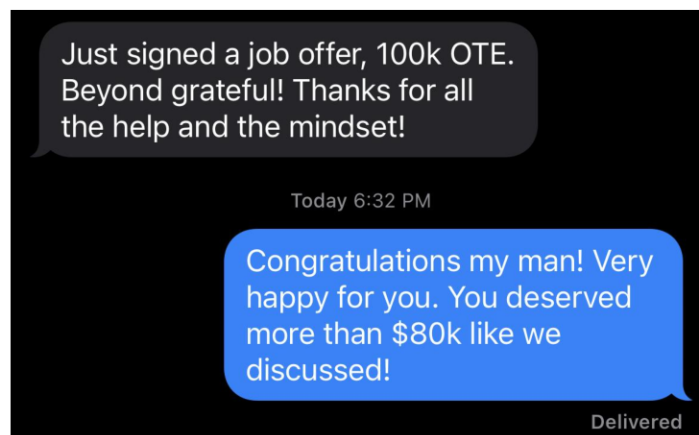
Acknowledgement	4
Table of Contents	5
Foreword	6
Where It Started	8
Introduction	10
Mindset Secrets	13
Unlimited Motivation	15
Giving Back	17
Types of Interviews	18
Interview Secrets	20
Before the Interview	20
During the Interviews	22
After the interview	26
Objection Handling	27
39 Toughest Interview Questions	29
What's Next?	61

Foreword

It was a usual Thursday evening. I had a tough workout at the gym. As I sat at my desk, I started thinking. Two weeks ago, I began helping someone who had just finished school in Toronto. Even though he was really smart, he was having a hard time getting the job he really wanted.

I believed in him and taught him how to find job opportunities, make a great resume, and do well in interviews. Finally, he got an interview. But, as time passed, and I didn't hear anything, I started to worry. I wondered if I had given him the right advice and if my help was good enough. I felt responsible for his career.

Luckily, on that Thursday evening, my worries went away. I got a message from him on my phone, and when I read it, I felt proud.



Not only had he landed the job of his dreams, but he had also secured an impressive salary, a staggering 20k more than his initial aspirations.

Since then I, through my company 'immigrant Ninja', have helped many who have gone on to make an additional \$6.9M(as of Dec 2023) using the very same methods you will learn in this book.

As a seasoned sales professional with over 3 years of experience and a 91% success rate in interviews, I know first-hand the importance of effectively communicating your value to potential employers.

This experience has given me a unique perspective and valuable insights into the interview process I am excited to share with you my methods in this book.

Methods that are not only effective but have been tested and backed by results.

Don't let yourself be held back by doubts and uncertainty, let me show you the way to securing the career and salary you deserve.

Where It Started

"The diamond cannot be polished without friction, nor man perfected without trials." - Chinese Proverb

Wednesday, June 15, 2021.

I will never forget this day. This is when the incident happened. My Ebike which I used to do Uber Eats with, was stolen. I felt a pit in my stomach as I realized the gravity of the situation. I immediately reported the theft to the police, but deep down I knew it was unlikely that I would ever see my e-bike again.

My e-bike was not only my mode of transportation, but it was also my livelihood. Without it, I had no way to make deliveries and earn money.

I couldn't sleep that night, my mind racing with thoughts of how I was going to make ends meet without my e-bike. The e-bike was a rental from a local company and now I had to pay them a fine of \$1200. I had put all my savings(\$2000) in crypto and the market had crashed by 70% a week ago. I knew no one in Toronto and my ego wouldn't have allowed me to call home and ask for help. In fact, I didn't even tell my parents about this incident for a few days. I knew my parents would have felt the stress. My mom especially would have lost sleep. (I am sure you can relate if you are from a brown family.)

The anxiety was overwhelming, and I felt like my whole world had crumbled around me. Since I was an international student at that time, it took a lot of work to make ends meet. At that time international students couldn't work more than 20hrs a week.

After a few sleepless nights, I got a job at a nearby restaurant. I was now making half of what I was making doing Uber Eats but it was something to keep my boat afloat. My winter break was going to start in August 2021 and I knew that I could then legally work full-time. I had some tech sales experience under my belt and I thought I would try in this field again.

Soon I landed 2 interviews. This is when I started learning about the skill of clearing interviews. I realized it is very similar to my prior experience in tech sales. It's just that in the job interview, we have to sell ourselves. I started using the same principles that I learnt earlier and 2 weeks later, I landed my first full-time job in Canada while still a student. It was my first 6-figure job. I used the same techniques and landed 2 other jobs for \$165k and \$185k each. By the time I graduated, I had cumulative offers of more than \$400k.

The surprising thing was that I got these jobs just based on my skills. This was contrary to the general belief that most people have. People think they have to go to a university, get good marks, choose a job related to their field and wait till they graduate to get a good full-time job. NOPE.

Introduction

*"You're doing sales because you failed at marketing.
You're doing marketing because you failed at the product."*

-Naval Ravikant

A good business has three parts in the order of priority:

1. Product
2. Marketing
3. Sales

"But Ishank I bought this book for my interview. Why are you talking about business?"

Give me 60 seconds. There is a good reason.

You only sell because you don't know how to market and you only market because you don't know how to build a good product. Building a good product will always be at the top. I learnt this recently when I went to a famous pizza shop here in Toronto - Pizza Badiali.

It is a small shop in a residential area. Quite contrary to the general belief that the restaurant has to be fancy and within a high-traffic area like a mall to make a lot of money. This small shop probably generates \$10k/day. There are lineups any time you go there and their slices of pizzas run out so fast. Why?

Coz they have built a good product. Their pizza is so good that people tell their friends. Even I am writing about them to explain a concept. Free marketing.

The same analogy can be used for your job hunt.

Product = Your Skill

Marketing = Resume, Cover Letter and LinkedIn

Sales = Interview Skills

Your focus should always be on building your skills. Be so good at what you do that people feel obliged to introduce you to others. Regardless of whether you are in design, web development, coding etc, you should be hard to replace. That is the secret to having a great career and a fat bank balance.

But if the product is the biggest priority, why am I writing a book on interview preparation/sales?

I have taken over 200 mock interviews in 'Immigrant Ninja Career Coaching'. I have realized that this is where we immigrants struggle the most. Why?

You see English is not our first language. We grew up speaking Hindi/Gujarati/Punjabi. If we have spoken these languages for 2 decades, we have to accept that our English will suck a little. That is okay because we can always improve. Especially when we have to compete for the same job with native English speakers.

See, you can hack your way to the job interview. You can ask someone like me to fix your resume and you can get an interview easily. But what happens after? There is no hack to the interview. You have to learn how to sell yourself. This is the mistake most people make. They never fix what they can fix, never take accountability and blame external factors for not getting a job.

I am sure you must have heard people complaining the game is rigged instead of learning how to play. The game will always be rigged for unskilled players.

This book will teach you the skill of interviewing. That is why this book is essential. This book focuses on the art of persuasion. This will teach you how to sell yourself. It has the frameworks, psychology tips and the exact answers that you need. If you want to be more confident in interviews, not be nervous, and tackle unexpected questions; this book is for you.

Mindset Secrets

"The only limit to our realization of tomorrow will be our doubts of today."

- Franklin D. Roosevelt

Congratulations for being among the few that do instead of many who just talk. Implementing what you learn is going to be tough. But that's exactly what will give you the results that you seek.

Why do you think most people are unhappy? It's because they have wrong expectations. Most people have champagne dreams and beer standards. Aspiring for an above-average life with a below-average work ethic is a sin.

Do not believe in the fallacy that life is easy. It gets tougher as you grow up. Marriage is tough. Having kids is tough. Raising kids going through puberty is tough. Parents/spouses getting sick and dying is tough. But, why am I bringing this point up in this book about interview preparation?

You might think that since you bought this book, you wouldn't have to work hard. You might think that you would skim through this book. You might think that you could read this like Harry Potter and have fun. WRONG!

Imagine this book to be your guide. It can lead you to the battle and help you prepare for it but it cannot fight the battle for you. You have to take accountability for your success. This also means taking accountability for your failure. You would have to practice what is taught in the book. You would have to grind when you don't feel like it. Be mentally prepared for it. No one is going to save you but yourself. There is no substitute for hard work.

80% of people who purchase a book never finish it. 15% never implement what they learn and only 5% get the results that they want. As you progress reading this book, your brain will start throwing in traps. Here are a few examples:

- While reading you might have the urge to check social media.
- While going through the checklists in the next chapters, you might get the urge to skip implementation or skim chapters.
- While going through the second half, a limiting belief might creep in that might echo “I am not good enough”. “Maybe I can't crack the interview”. “Maybe this book is useless”.

Identify these traps. I know you are wise. I can tell you have the urge to succeed. Please limit negative self-talk. Limiting beliefs are the heaviest weights holding you down. The priority of our brain is survival. It is not a success. Your brain wants to keep you safe from everything unpredictable. But you know growth is not in the comfort zone. To get your pot of gold, you would have to confront the dragon and slay it. Yes, it is not easy. Yes, it will make you uncomfortable. Yes, your spirit might break in the process but trust me the gold that the dragon protects is well worth it. (dragon is the metaphor for fear and gold is the metaphor for your goal)

Do not make the mistake of giving in to the voices in your head. The voice in your head might tell you to skip a few chapters or ignore what is taught here but remember that all shortcuts to success ultimately lead to misery.

Your thoughts become your beliefs. Your beliefs become your words. Your words dictate your actions. Your actions shape your life.

Aim higher. Be better.

Unlimited Motivation

"Effort only fully releases its reward after a person refuses to quit."

- Napoleon Hill

The process of getting a job in Western countries is elaborate. Primarily because of the absence of on-campus placements. What to do when you face self-doubt when you think you are not good enough When you feel like there is no point in doing anything. What if you lose motivation to finish this book?

Well, the first secret is not to rely on motivation at all. Understand that it is an emotion and emotions are fleeting. For you to be driven, it has to come from a rational vision instead of an emotion.

How to find that vision? Guided meditation. It sounds fancy but it's fairly simple. I do this now and then. Sit on a flat surface. Not your mattress. A floor/yoga mat is better. Cross your legs and place both hands in your lap with your palms up. Before you start this exercise, put on any soundtrack by Hans Zimmer. Trust me. It works like magic. Close your eyes. Inhale through your nose and exhale through your mouth. Deep breaths. The visualization is divided into 2 parts:

1. Think of a time in the past when it was challenging but you still won. It could be a match of gully cricket. It could be you hitting your personal record in the gym. It could be anything. The requirement is that the obstacles have to be big and you should have overcome them. If the voice inside you says “We haven't done anything in life yet”, it's wrong. I truly believe that if you are alive, you have seen tough times and overcome them. Think of how you defeated your demons. Think of how you won. This visualization should help with your limiting beliefs.

2. Now think why you want a better life. Often we are selfish to think about ourselves here. A better idea is to think about the people that would benefit if you make it. I always think of my parents, especially my mom. She has sacrificed so much for me and I would do anything to make it up to her.

Think about what you would want to do for your family. Go into the details. Imagine your parents smiling faces. Imagine your happy kids eating ice cream. Imagine your proud wife hugging you. Savour the moments. I often cry when I imagine this. You might too. It is normal. Channel this emotion into action. That's the secret to unlimited motivation.

Giving Back

"We make a living by what we get, but we make a life by what we give."

- Winston Churchill

Your life will not be judged based on the money you made, the countries you travelled or the cars you owned. It will be judged on the impact you had on others. Several scientific studies prove that people who help others experience higher fulfilment in life. I am trying to do the same thing with all the content I produce including this book.

The only way I can succeed in my quest to change a million lives is if this reaches out to more people. A lot of the success of this book would be judged by its reviews.

If you found this book valuable, please send your honest feedback to ishank@immigrantninja.com. It's free and would take less than 60 seconds.

P.S. If you know someone who is looking to land their dream job, please refer them to this book. As of 2023, I am putting content on LinkedIn, YouTube and Instagram. You can search for my name on these platforms to find me. Please use the free resources and share them with someone you care about.

Types of Interviews

Before we dive into the juicy parts, you need to know the type of interview you would be appearing for. The rules don't change around how you sell but the context changes little in each type.

In-person interviews: This is the traditional type of interview, where the candidate meets with the interviewer face-to-face.

Phone interviews: A phone interview is a pre-screening interview typically used by employers to narrow down the pool of candidates before inviting them for an in-person interview.

Video interviews: Video interviews are becoming increasingly popular, especially with the rise of remote work. These interviews are conducted via video conferencing software, such as Zoom or Skype.

Group interviews: Group interviews involve multiple candidates being interviewed at the same time by a group of interviewers. This type of interview is often used to assess a candidate's ability to work in a team.

Behavioural interviews: Behavioral interviews focus on a candidate's past experiences and behaviour to predict their future performance. These interviews typically involve the interviewer asking questions about specific situations the candidate has been in and how they handled them.

Technical interviews: Technical interviews are used to assess a candidate's knowledge and skills related to a specific technical field, such as programming or engineering.

Case interviews: Case interviews are commonly used in consulting and investment banking. They involve a candidate presented with a business problem or scenario and asked to analyze and provide a solution.

Interview Secrets

"By failing to prepare, you are preparing to fail."

- Benjamin Franklin

Before the Interview

Interview preparation: Acing interviews is a skill to be learned. It is not something that comes naturally to anyone. Set your expectations accordingly. Practice is essential and I don't mean repeating things in your head. The answers should be verbally spoken.

So, how do you practice your interview? (from best to worst)

#1 Use the frameworks given in the book and formulate your answers.

#2 Stand in front of the mirror and practice each answer at least 10 times until you are speaking fluent English.

#3 Ask a friend of yours to interview you. Ask them to ask you tough questions.

Learn about the interview process - Each company adopts a different interview process and each interview round is intended for a certain purpose. There can be a group interview, phone screening call, technical rounds where your skill will be tested or final rounds where salary would be negotiated. You need to understand the goals of the employer for each round. There are 2 ways to do this:

- Go to Glassdoor and see the interview section. You will learn so much about the process of a certain company. Only do this after you land an interview. Save time.
- Talk to existing employees of that company over LinkedIn. Personal insights can be very rewarding.
- Ask HR regarding the agenda of the next round. You will be surprised how helpful the HRs can be.

Control nervousness - Lower $\frac{1}{3}$ of your lungs are responsible for $\frac{2}{3}$ of your oxygen. When we are nervous, we breathe shallowly and hence we do not get enough oxygen. As a result, our results are not ideal. Practice slow and deep breaths before the interview to combat nervousness.

You can also use mindset awareness to be more confident during the interview. Cool fact - the interviewer is just as nervous as you. You can transmute the emotion of nervousness into excitement. Look at it as an opportunity you were looking for instead of a mistake that will cost you. Your perspective shapes your reality.

Research - You should know what the company does, who it sells to and who its competitors are. You can get most of this info from the company website. See their blog or go to their social media. Dig out what you need. You should also look for the company's mission and values. This would come in handy during the interview.

Researching the job roles, salaries and company reviews on Glassdoor is essential. It's better to wait for a month for a better job than to accept a job out of desperation.

Dress Up - All interviews have to be treated formally. Do not make the mistake of thinking otherwise. Do not show up in a hoody and a hat. If you are a Sardar, wear your turban instead of a cap. You can never be overdressed for an interview.

Revision - Prepare answers to common interview questions. Review chapter 5 of this book before an interview. Repetition makes ideas stick.

In-Person Interview - If it is an in-person interview then plan your transit route the day before. Take extra copies of your resume as a backup. Shine your shoes.

Good Sleep - This is essential for optimal performance. Do not stay up late. Do the visualization exercise in the earlier chapter and relax.

During the Interview

Smile - Before they choose you, they first have to like you. Smiling increases your probability of being liked. Smile even on the phone interviews. You would be surprised to notice how your voice changes when you smile.

Be memorable - You won't be the only one interviewing for the position; hence, you have to be memorable. Here are a few tricks I use:

1. I started video interviews with Namaste. Then I explain what it means. I show gratitude. This makes them feel special. It also separates me from the crowd.
2. I talk about my experience as an immigrant. I mention my goal of bringing my parents here. This makes them emotionally invested.
3. I tell short stories. Stories are the oldest form of persuasion. Stories modulate human emotions and hence are the most memorable form of human communication.

Show enthusiasm - Express your excitement about the opportunity to work for the company and the role you are interviewing for. Share your passion for the industry, the company's mission, or the specific work that you would be doing. Dull people are not fun to work with. Do not make the mistake of sounding too serious/robotic.

Be confident but not arrogant - Show that you are confident in your abilities and qualifications, but also be humble and open to feedback. This shows that you are capable and self-assured, but also that you are willing to learn and grow. Being humble and open to feedback is a desirable trait, and a company wants to know they can rely on you and that you have a good attitude.

Show your personality - Be yourself and let your personality shine through in the interview. This can help the interviewer get a sense of who you are as a person and whether you would be a good fit for the company culture.

Show up early - If it is an in-person interview then arrive 30 minutes early. Why?

- To find the address/building of the company.
- To complete check-in procedures.
- To find the location and office where the interview shall take place;
- To check your appearance before getting into the interview room.

If it is a virtual interview then log on 10 minutes early. Your application or machine might need an update and taking things to the last can be detrimental.

Ask Tough Questions - An average man prepares what to say. A better man prepares what to ask. You will be judged based on your questions. Take examples from chapter 5. Your questions will make you stand out from the crowd.

Body language - Do not slouch. Do not chew gum. Maintain eye contact. Have a firm handshake. Put your phone on DND. Do not fiddle with your hair/clothes.

Use CAR - The acronym stands for Challenge, Action and Result. Use this framework for your answers. You can use the same framework to answer behavioural questions.

Learn traits/skills that all employers look for in every applicant - Being resourceful and problem-solving is a common skill involved in any job. Whether you plan to work as a construction labourer or as a manager at a major corporation, all jobs will involve problems and only solving such problems may lead to your success. It is imperative that before entering the interview room, you should know how to approach and solve problems. All questions should be answered with this process in mind.

Close your sale before leaving - You have to close the deal before you leave.

Remember here you are selling yourself. It's no different than selling a product; you need to get a yes from the buyer. You should understand that a refusal is challenging, however, that doesn't necessarily mean a no, but that the buyer is not ready to buy. Don't apologize for what you don't have. If you cannot persuade the interviewers, try to get a reason from them. Objections do not always mean rejections, but you have to cause them to be open to respond effectively. It's always worth trying.

Be articulate- An easy way to lose a job opportunity is to speak too much. Most people blabber when they are nervous. This makes you look foolish. Most people make the mistake of not framing the answers before giving the actual answer.

Eg. What did you have for lunch?

Wrong Way- I went to this amazing pizza shop close to the waterfront. The weather was so good. It was a sunny day. I had a great time there. I had a pepperoni pizza.

The Right Way- I had a pepperoni pizza. I went to this amazing pizza shop close to the waterfront.

Expert - For you to sell yourself in the interview. You have to appear as an expert in the field. Anything that proves your authority should be at your fingertips. Memorize and rehearse your career stats and don't be shy to present when you see the opportunity. Each job requires different aspects of knowledge and skills, however, according to Robert Lawrence, there are 7 traits as mentioned below that play the most important role and that are sought after by any employer: • Skillset • Team player • Attitude • Professionalism • Leadership • Ethic • Security

Tonality- There are 3 tonalities we humans use.

#1 Authority - We often use this when talking to a younger sibling.

#2 Neutral - We often use this while talking to a peer.

#3 Seeking Rapport- We often use this while talking to a policeman.

Do not make the mistake of using the first. 2nd or 3rd is ideal. I usually use the 2nd.

Body Language - 93% of communication is nonverbal. What you say is only 7%.

Make sure to use your hands and your facial expressions to communicate. Do not sit with a pumpkin face.

Build Rapport - Always do this at the beginning of the interview. Make the interviewer feel comfortable. The more comfortable they are, the tougher questions you can ask. Learn small talk. Ask about their day. Find conversations from conversations. Eg. I had an interviewer call me from California. So I asked her about the NBA coz the Golden State Warriors were going to play finals soon.

Timeline - One way to combat anxiety after the interview is to ask about the timeline and turnaround time. Most of the time from the answer you can judge if you cleared the round or not. You can also know when should you be expecting an answer.

Do not interrupt - Let them finish their sentence. Do not interrupt. Do not seem rude in your behaviour. Be patient if you are feeling excited to share a point or answers.

Do not Argue - Under any circumstance, you should not be involved in a back-and-forth. Always take accountability and show your trait of being coachable.

After the interview

Send a thank-you note or email - Send a thank-you note or email within 24 hours of the interview to thank the interviewer for their time and to reiterate your interest in the role.

Follow up on the next steps - if you haven't received any update, follow up within that timeframe to inquire about the status of your application.

Reflect on your performance - Take some time to reflect on the interview and identify areas where you could improve for future interviews.

Keep searching - Most people make the mistake of not continuing to apply for new jobs after a few interviews. The more options you have, the more leverage you will have during negotiation. More options will also reduce your stress.

Be open-minded - Be open-minded about different roles and industries that may be a good fit for your skills and experience. Even if a position isn't exactly what you're looking for, it could still be a valuable stepping stone to your dream job.

Be persistent - Even if you don't get the job, don't give up. Keep applying and interviewing, and eventually, you will find the right opportunity.

Objection Handling

"Selling is not a pushy, winner-takes-all, macho act. It is an empathy-led, process-driven, and knowledge-intensive discipline."

- Jill Konrath

One of the biggest reasons people don't clear interviews is that they do not know how to handle objections. There would rarely be an interview without objections where the company is serious about hiring you. If you are an immigrant, one major objection you would get would be the lack of international experience.

Here are some objection-handling tips.

Listen actively: Pay attention to the objection and understand the concern before responding.

Acknowledge the objection: Show that you understand and validate the concern and that you take it seriously.

Address the concern: Provide specific examples or evidence that address the concern and reassure the interviewer.

Ask clarifying questions: If you are not sure what the interviewer is looking for, ask questions to better understand the concern.

Offer a solution: If possible, provide a potential solution or action plan to address the concern.

Remain positive: Maintain a positive and confident attitude throughout the interview, even when faced with objections.

Practice: Practice handling objections in mock interviews or with a career counsellor to improve your skills.

One advanced way of handling objections is to block them beforehand. I learnt this from my sales experience. Before the customer could object that the product is expensive, I would say “There is a possibility that you think this is expensive. But here is why it is the best solution for your business.... ”

You can use the same example and pivot. It is a fact that everyone knows what their weaknesses are. Or the reasons why they shouldn't be hired. You should have answers to these questions beforehand. This is a very potent tool if you use this right. I blocked objections in the introduction chapter of this book. See if you can spot it.

39 Toughest Interview Questions

Q1- Tell me about yourself.

I answer this using a simple framework from my sales experience- WWW

W- Who are you?

W- What do you do?

W- What is in it for them?

Since they know your name you don't need to explain the first W. In the other 2 Ws, you can talk about your results, your motivation for being into a certain field of work and most importantly your character traits. Mentioning traits like enthusiasm, industriousness and coachability goes a long way.

It's also important to note that most job roles require very specific skills or traits.

These will be essential in your quest to sell yourself. If you know what the customer wants then you can shape your answer accordingly. There are 2 ways to do this:

- You can look it up in the job description to frame your answer.
- After answering the question, the interviewer, "Is there anything specific

you would want me to elaborate on?"

Example- "I am an experienced sales professional with a proven track record of success in building and maintaining relationships with clients. I have over 3 years of experience in sales, with a focus on the SAAS industry. I have a strong understanding of the sales process and am skilled in identifying and pursuing new business opportunities. My ability to build strong relationships with clients and my

strong negotiation skills have led to consistently exceeding sales targets. I have closed over \$500k with an average of 110% quota attainment. I am enthusiastic, industrious and coachable.” I usually use more numbers but the above is just an example for you.

Traps to Avoid- This question is simple yet most candidates are disqualified due to their incomplete/wrong answers to this question. Avoid providing too much personal information that is not relevant to the job. Employers don't care that you have a dog or you like pizzas. Avoid being too vague or general, not tailoring your response to the specific job or company, not highlighting your achievements, speaking too much or too long, lacking enthusiasm or self-confidence, and not emphasizing how you can benefit the company. Keep your answer under 40 seconds.

Q2- Why do you want to work here?

When answering this question, it's important to show that you have done your research on the company and understand its mission, values, and goals. You should also demonstrate how your skills and experience align with the company's needs and how you can contribute to its success. Here are some tips for answering this question:

- **Research the company:** Review the company's website, mission statement, and recent news or press releases to gain a better understanding of its values, goals, and culture.
- **Tailor your answer:** Show that you understand the specific needs of the company and how your skills and experience align with them.
- **Highlight your achievements:** Show that you have a track record of success in your field and that you are a valuable asset to the company.
- **Emphasize your passion for the industry:** Show that you are passionate about the industry and that you are excited to be a part of the company.

- Show enthusiasm: Show that you are excited about the opportunity to work at the company and contribute to its success.

Example: "I am excited about the opportunity to work at XYZ company because of its strong reputation in the industry and its commitment to innovation and sustainability. My experience in marketing, combined with my passion for the technology industry aligns well with the company's mission, and I believe I can make a valuable contribution to the growth and success of the company. I am particularly impressed with the company's recent initiatives in the field of AI, and I would love to be a part of a team that is driving such innovative projects."

Traps to Avoid- Researching the company to sound like an encyclopedia and showing off is not preferred. Do not talk about things that make you look selfish.

Q3- What are your biggest strengths?

When answering this question, it's important to highlight skills and qualities that are relevant to the job you are applying for. Here are some tips for answering this question:

- Research the job and company: Review the job description and research the company to understand the specific skills and qualifications that are required for the role.
- Tailor your answer: Highlight skills and qualities that align with the job requirements and demonstrate how they make you a strong fit for the role.
- Use examples: Provide specific examples of how you have used your strengths in past roles to achieve success.
- Be honest and confident: Be honest about your strengths and speak confidently about them.
- Highlight transferable skills: If you don't have direct experience in the field, highlight transferable skills that you have that can be applied to the role.

Example- "One of my biggest strengths is my ability to think strategically and creatively when solving problems. I have a strong analytical mind and can identify patterns and trends in data. This has helped me in my past roles to identify new business opportunities and optimize sales processes. I am also a strong communicator and can effectively communicate complex ideas to both technical and non-technical audiences. I am confident that these skills will be an asset in the role of a Business Analyst at your company."

Traps to Avoid- sounding arrogant, being too modest, listing skills or strengths that are not relevant, not providing examples, or lying or exaggerating.

Q4- What are your biggest weaknesses?

It's important to provide a genuine and honest answer while also showing that you are actively working to improve or overcome those weaknesses. Here are some tips for answering this question:

- Identify a real weakness: Be honest about a weakness that you have and how it has affected your work in the past.
- Show how you are addressing it: Demonstrate that you are aware of your weakness and are taking steps to improve or overcome it.
- Highlight a positive aspect: Show how your weakness can also be a strength, for example, how being detail-oriented can make you a better quality control analyst.
- Keep it relevant: Choose a weakness that is relevant to the job and company you are applying for.

Example: "One of my biggest weaknesses is my tendency to be a perfectionist, which can sometimes lead to me spending too much time on small details and not moving on to other tasks. I have been working on managing my time more effectively by setting clear deadlines and prioritizing tasks. This has helped me to be more

productive and efficient in my work. Additionally, being a perfectionist also makes me pay attention to the small details which are important in quality control and ensuring accuracy in my work."

Traps- avoid sounding overly negative, vague, or self-deprecating. Emphasize that you are actively working to improve and overcome your weaknesses and that you are confident in your ability to do so.

Q5- Why did you leave your last job?

It's important, to be honest, and professional and avoid speaking negatively about your previous employer. Here are some tips for answering this question: Be honest: Provide a clear and honest reason for why you left your last job.

- Highlight the positive: Emphasize any positive aspects of your decision to leave, such as seeking new challenges or wanting to learn new skills.
- Avoid being negative: Avoid speaking negatively about your previous employer or colleagues, it can make you appear unprofessional.
- Keep it concise: Provide a clear and concise answer and avoid going into too much detail.
- Show growth: Show that you have learned from the experience and have grown as a professional.

Example- "I left my last job because I was looking for new challenges and opportunities to grow my skills. I had been with the company for a long time, and while I appreciate the experience and knowledge I gained there, I felt that it was time for me to take on new challenges. I am excited about the opportunity to bring my skills and experience to a new company and continue growing as a professional."

Traps to Avoid- speaking negatively, lying, being vague, not showing growth and being too personal. Emphasize any positive aspects of your decision, and show that you have learned from the experience and have grown as a professional.

Q6- What are your career goals?

it's important to show that you have a clear understanding of your long-term career aspirations and how they align with the company's mission and values. Here are some tips for answering this question:

- Research the company: Review the company's mission statement, goals, and values to understand how they align with your career aspirations.
- Be specific: Provide specific examples of your career goals and how you plan to achieve them.
- Show ambition: Show that you are ambitious and motivated to advance in your career.
- Show alignment with company goals: Explain how your career goals align with the company's goals and mission.

Example: "My long-term career goal is to become a senior manager in the field of marketing. I am passionate about the industry and have been working hard to gain the skills and experience needed to excel in a leadership role. I have a solid understanding of the marketing landscape, and I am well-versed in the latest marketing techniques, technologies and best practices. I have a track record of delivering results and I am confident that my skills and experience will help me to achieve my goal and also align with the company's objectives. I am excited about the opportunity to bring my skills and experience to your company and contribute to its continued growth and success."

Traps to Avoid- being vague, unrealistic, self-centred, or unambitious in your answer.

Q7- What are your salary expectations?

it is important to consider the stage of the interview process. If it is early on, such as the first or second interview, the interviewer may be using this question to eliminate candidates. In this case, it is best to avoid giving a specific salary expectation, and

instead, ask for more information about the role and the company's approved salary range. If pressed for a number, give a wide range, rather than a specific number. It is also important to research the typical salary range for the position and industry to have realistic expectations. By avoiding giving a specific salary expectation and showing flexibility and openness to negotiation, you increase your chances of remaining a strong candidate throughout the selection process.

Scenario: You are in the first round of interviews for a sales manager position.

Interviewer: "What are your salary expectations for this position?"

Answer: "What budget are you working around?" or maybe give a wide range and then ask this question.

Interviewer: "The salary range for this position is \$80,000 - \$100,000 per year, does that work for you?"

Answer: "That salary range works for me, thank you for sharing."

Scenario: You are in the final round of interviews and discussing salary

Interviewer: "What are your salary expectations for this position?"

Answer: "I have done my research and based on my experience and qualifications, I am looking for a salary in the range of \$97,000 - \$105,000 per year, including benefits and bonuses. I understand that this is negotiable, and I am open to discussing the compensation package further." either give a tight range in this scenario or give a specific number.

Traps to Avoid- giving a tight range in the initial interview and a wide range in the final interview. Avoid vague numbers that are not based on market trends.

Q8- Why should we hire you?

It is important to highlight your qualifications and experience that make you a strong fit for the position. Additionally, you can discuss your enthusiasm and motivation for the job, as well as any specific skills or strengths that you can bring to the company.

Example: "I believe I would be a great fit for this position because of my experience and qualifications. I have [X number of years/relevant experience or degree] in [relevant field], and I have demonstrated my ability to [relevant skills or accomplishments]. I am very enthusiastic about the opportunity to work for your company, and I am confident that my skills and experience make me an excellent candidate for the position. Additionally, I am a fast learner, and a team player and have good communication skills which will be an asset to the company. "

Traps to Avoid- being too general, sounding arrogant, speaking negatively about previous employers, forgetting to ask questions, sounding rehearsed and exaggerating your skills and experience.

Q9- Tell me about a time you failed.

When answering this question, it's important, to be honest, and reflective about a failure you've experienced in the past, and to demonstrate how you learned from it and grew as a result. Here is an example of how you might answer this question:

Example: "One time I failed was when I was leading a team on a project at my previous job. We had a tight deadline and I didn't manage the team's workload effectively, which led to some team members feeling overwhelmed and a few critical tasks falling behind schedule. I learned from this experience that clear communication and delegation are key to managing a successful team, and I made sure to implement these strategies in my future projects. Additionally, I proactively identified and addressed the issue with my manager and my team, we worked together to come up with solutions and eventually, we were able to deliver the project on time. Through this failure, I learned valuable lessons about leadership and team management."

It is important to keep in mind that you should always frame the failure positively and explain how you learned from it, and how you can use this learning to be a better employee for the company.

Traps to Avoid- being vague. it's important to give a specific example, take responsibility for the failure, not blame others, not make up a failure, focus on the learning and growth from the experience, and show that you have moved on from the failure and are ready to tackle new challenges in the future.

Q10- Why have you chosen this particular field/role?

It's important to share your passion and motivation for the field, as well as how your skills and experience align with the role. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Share your personal story and how you became interested in the field.
- Explain what you find most exciting or fulfilling about the field.
- Highlight your relevant skills and experience and how they align with the role.
- Show your enthusiasm for the company and how the role aligns with your career aspirations.
- Share any specific goals or projects you hope to work on in the role.

Example: "I have always been passionate about sales. I first became interested in it when I was working as a customer service representative and I was fascinated by the way sales professionals were able to build relationships with clients and help businesses grow. Since then, I have gained several years of experience in sales, and I have come to appreciate the challenge of building relationships with clients and the satisfaction of closing deals. I am excited about the opportunity to work with a team of experts at [company name] and to contribute to the company's mission and values by increasing sales in the [specific market/product line]. I am confident that my skills and experience align well with this sales role and I am looking forward to the opportunity to grow and develop within the company."

Traps to Avoid- not showing enough passion or enthusiasm, being too general or vague, and focusing too much on personal gain.

Q11- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

When answering this question in a job interview, it's important to strike a balance between being honest about your career aspirations and being realistic about the opportunities available within the company. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Show your enthusiasm for the company and the role you're interviewing for.
- Share specific goals or accomplishments you hope to achieve in the next 5 years, such as learning new skills or taking on more responsibilities.
- Highlight how your long-term goals align with the company's mission and values.
- Express your willingness to grow and develop within the company, rather than focusing solely on advancement opportunities.
- Be honest and realistic about your career aspirations and how the company can help you achieve them.

Example: In the next five years, I hope to continue growing and developing my skills as a [position you applied for]. I am excited about the opportunity to work with a team of experts and I am looking forward to contributing to the company's mission and values by taking on additional responsibilities and making a meaningful impact. I am also looking forward to developing my skills to be a team leader and help the company achieve its goals.

Traps to Avoid- Do not say “in your position”, or “the CEO of this company“. Don’t sound arrogant.

Q12- Aren’t you overqualified for this position?

When an interviewer asks if you're overqualified for the position, it's important to reframe the question and highlight the advantages of hiring someone with your level of experience. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Acknowledge the tight job market and explain how your strong experience can benefit the company.
- Emphasize how your experience can help you start contributing immediately, and how your past training and experience from other companies can benefit the company without additional costs.
- Highlight how your experience can help the company in areas such as hiring, training, and motivation.
- Emphasize your commitment to finding a long-term role and your willingness to stay with the company for the long term.
- Show your enthusiasm for the company the role you're interviewing for, and how it aligns with your career aspirations.

Example: “I understand where you're coming from, but I see this as an opportunity for both of us. My extensive experience in this field has provided me with the skills and knowledge to make an immediate impact in this position. I also see this as an opportunity to grow with the company and take on additional responsibilities in the future. I'm excited about the possibility of joining your team and making a long-term commitment to the company.”

The main concern behind the “overqualified” question is that you will leave your new employer as soon as something better comes your way. Anything you can say to demonstrate the sincerity of your commitment to the employer and reassuring him that you're looking to stay for the long term will help you overcome this objection.

Traps to Avoid- being defensive or dismissive, emphasizing your qualifications too much, being too specific or unrealistic about your long-term goals, giving the impression that you're only interested in the job as a stepping stone, or being vague or non-committal about your commitment to the company.

Q13- Do you have any questions?

Here are some top questions to ask the interviewer during a job interview:

- "What are the biggest challenges facing the department/company and how does this role contribute to addressing those challenges?"
- "Can you tell me about the team I will be working with and the company culture?"
- "What are the opportunities for growth and development within the company?"
- "What is the expectation for the first 90 days on the job?"
- "What are the company's plans for the next few years and how does this role fit into those plans?"
- "Can you tell me more about the performance evaluation process and how it is used to support employee growth and development?"
- "What kind of support and resources are available to help me be successful in this role?"
- "Can you tell me about any specific projects or initiatives that I would be working on in this role?"
- "Can you tell me about the path that led to the current position of the person who previously held this role?"

And my favourite question:

- "Based on the conversation that we had, would there be any reason you won't hire me?"

Q14- Walk me through your resume.

When an interviewer asks you to "walk them through your resume," they are asking you to provide a brief overview of your education, work experience, and relevant skills and qualifications. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Start with your most recent education or work experience and work backwards.
- Emphasize the most relevant or transferable skills and experience that you have acquired from your previous positions.

- Highlight any accomplishments or successes that you have had in your previous positions.
- Explain any gaps in your work history or any relevant volunteer or extracurricular activities you have been involved in.
- End by summarizing how your skills and experience align with the role you are interviewing for.

Example: "Starting with my education, I have a Bachelor's degree in [relevant field] from [university]. After that, I started working as a [position] at [company], where I gained experience in [specific skills or responsibilities]. After that, I moved on to work in a [position] at [company], where I was responsible for [specific responsibilities] and was able to [accomplishments or successes]. I then took a brief break to [reason for the gap in work history]. Afterwards, I returned to work as a [position]."

Traps to Avoid- not highlighting relevant skills, not mentioning accomplishments, not explaining gaps in work history and not linking your experience to the role being applied for.

Q15- What do you know about our organization?

it's important to show that you have done your research and have a good understanding of the company's mission, values, products or services, and current initiatives. Here are some tips for answering this question:

- **Research the company:** Review the company's website, mission statement, recent news or press releases, and any other available information to gain a better understanding of its values, goals, products or services, and current initiatives.
- **Tailor your answer:** Show that you understand the specific needs of the company and how your skills and experience align with them.
- **Highlight achievements:** Mention any notable achievements or awards the company has received that you find impressive

- Show enthusiasm: Show that you are excited about the opportunity to work for the company and contribute to its success.
- Ask questions: If you are not sure about something, it's better to ask a question than to assume.

Example: "I have done a lot of research on your organization and I am impressed with the company's commitment to innovation and sustainability. I have learned that your company is a leader in the industry, and has been recognized for its cutting-edge technology and products. I am particularly interested in the company's recent initiatives in the field of AI and I believe that my experience in product development would be an asset to the team. I am excited about the opportunity to work for such a well-respected company and contribute to its continued success."

Traps to Avoid- appearing unprepared by researching the company beforehand, giving general or vague information, providing inaccurate or outdated information, being overly critical, and not showing enthusiasm.

Q16- Why was there a gap in your employment?

When an interviewer asks about a gap in your employment, it's important, to be honest, and provide a clear and concise explanation. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Be honest and straightforward about the reason for the gap.
- Keep your explanation brief and to the point, and avoid going into unnecessary details.
- Highlight any relevant activities or accomplishments you achieved during the gap, such as taking care of a family member, volunteering, or pursuing further education.
- Emphasize how this gap has made you a better candidate for the role.

- Show that you are eager to return to work and the gap is not going to be an issue in the future.

Example: "I took a brief break in my career to take care of my [family member], it was a personal decision but it was an opportunity for me to grow and gain new skills, such as [relevant skills/experience], I also took some classes in [relevant field], which I believe will make me a better candidate for the role."

It's important to remember that gaps in employment can happen for various reasons, it could be a personal decision or due to circumstances beyond your control. Be honest and confident in your answer, and emphasize how the gap has made you a stronger candidate.

Traps to Avoid- lying, being evasive, providing too much information, not highlighting relevant activities or accomplishments during the gap, and not emphasizing how the gap has made you a better candidate. Be honest, and brief and show how the gap has made you a stronger candidate.

Q17- Why did you change career paths?

When an interviewer asks about a change in your career path, it's important to provide a clear and concise explanation that highlights your motivation, goals, and how your skills and experience align with the new role. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Be honest about your reasons for the change and your motivation for the new career path.
- Explain how your skills and experience align with the new role and the industry you are entering
- Highlight any relevant education, training or certifications that have prepared you for the new role.
- Emphasize your passion and excitement for the new field and the company.

- Show that you have done your research and are well-informed about the new industry.

Example: "I have always had a passion for [new field]. I started my career in [previous field], but I realized that I wanted to pursue a career in [new field] after taking a [course/program] and learning more about the industry. I am excited about the opportunity to use my [relevant skills and experience] in a new role. I have also taken [relevant education, training or certifications] to prepare me for this new career path. I am confident that my skills and experience align well with this role, and I am excited about the opportunity to work with a team of experts at [company name] and to contribute to the company's mission and values."

Traps to Avoid- not being honest, not highlighting relevant skills, not showing passion for the new path, and not showing research on the new industry.

Q18- How do you handle failure?

When an interviewer asks about how you handle failure, they want to know how you react to setbacks and challenges, and how you learn from them. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Be honest about a specific instance of failure and how you handled it.
- Show how you took responsibility for the failure and how you learned from it.
- Emphasize the actions you took to prevent similar failures in the future.
- Highlight any positive outcome or lessons learned from the failure.
- Show that you are resilient and that you can move on from failure and continue to work towards your goals.

Example: "I have faced failure in the past, one specific instance was when I was leading a project and we missed the deadline. I took responsibility for the failure, I analyzed what went wrong and I learned that I didn't properly communicate the expectations and timelines with my team. I made sure to improve my communication skills, I also implemented regular check-ins and progress reports to keep everyone

on track. As a result, I was able to complete the next project on time and under budget. I learned that failure is a part of the process and it's important to learn from it and move forward."

Traps to Avoid- not giving a specific example, not taking responsibility, not mentioning actions taken to prevent future failures, not highlighting positive outcomes or lessons learned, and not showing resilience.

Q19- Give an example of how you handled a challenge in the workplace before.

When an interviewer asks for an example of how you handled a challenge in the workplace, they want to see how you handle stress and difficult situations, and how you approach problem-solving. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Give a specific example of a challenge you faced in the workplace and how you handled it.
- Explain the steps you took to address the challenge and the actions you took to resolve it.
- Highlight any relevant skills or experience that helped you handle the challenge.
- Show how the challenge was ultimately resolved and the outcome achieved.
- Emphasize any lessons you learned and how you have applied them to your work.

Example: "One challenge I faced in the workplace was when I was leading a project and the team was struggling to meet the deadline. I quickly realized that the root cause of the problem was a lack of clear communication and a lack of a detailed project plan. To address the challenge, I started by holding regular team meetings to ensure everyone was on the same page. I also developed a detailed project plan, with specific milestones and deadlines.

By implementing these changes, the team was able to complete the project on time and within budget. Through this experience, I learned the importance of clear communication and planning in project management."

Traps to Avoid- not giving a specific example, not explaining the steps taken, not highlighting relevant skills or experience, not mentioning the outcome and not emphasizing lessons learned.

Q20- Tell me about a time you had a conflict with your colleague and how the situation was resolved.

When an interviewer asks about a time you had a conflict with a colleague and how the situation was resolved, they want to see how you handle conflicts and how you approach resolving them. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Give a specific example of a conflict with a colleague and the circumstances surrounding it.
- Explain how you approached the situation and how you attempted to resolve the conflict.
- Highlight any relevant communication or negotiation skills that you used to resolve the conflict.
- Show how the conflict was ultimately resolved and the outcome achieved.
- Emphasize any lessons you learned and how you have applied them to your work.

Example: "One time, I had a conflict with a colleague over a project we were working on together. We had different ideas on how to approach the project and we were having trouble finding common ground. I took the initiative to schedule a meeting with my colleague to discuss our differences and try to find a solution. During the meeting, I actively listened to my colleague's perspective and we were able to come to a compromise that satisfied both of our concerns. We were able to complete the project successfully and we even received positive feedback from our

manager. From this experience, I learned the importance of active listening and effective communication in resolving conflicts."

It's important to show that you have attempted to resolve the conflict professionally and effectively and that you have learned from the experience.

Traps to Avoid- avoid not providing a specific example, not explaining how you approached the situation, not highlighting relevant skills, not mentioning the outcome, and not emphasizing lessons learned. Do not look like a negative influence and a troublemaker.

Q21- Do you prefer working independently or on a team?

When an interviewer asks if you prefer working independently or on a team, they want to understand your working style and how you function in different working environments. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Be honest about your preferences, but also emphasize your ability to work effectively in both environments.
- Explain how you have successfully worked in both independent and team settings in the past.
- Highlight any relevant skills or experience that contribute to your ability to work well in both environments.
- Show your willingness to adapt to the needs of the company and the specific role.
- Emphasize your ability to collaborate and communicate effectively with others.

Example: "I am comfortable working both independently and on a team. I have experience working on solo projects, where I was able to take ownership of the project and deliver it on time. At the same time, I have also worked on team projects, where I was able to collaborate and contribute my skills to reach a common goal."

I believe that my ability to adapt and communicate effectively makes me a valuable asset in any working environment. I am open to working in any capacity that is required to achieve the company's goals and the specific role's requirements."

Traps to Avoid- Avoid leaning on extreme ends. This can alienate you very easily. Show moderation in your answer.

Q22- What did you like least about your last job?

When an interviewer asks about what you liked least about your last job, they want to understand your level of satisfaction with your previous employment and if any red flags might indicate that you would be unhappy in the new role. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Be honest, but be mindful of how you present your answer, as it should be positive and professional.
- Avoid criticizing specific individuals or the company as a whole, focus instead on specific aspects of the job or work environment.
- If possible, explain how you tried to address the issue, and what you learned from the experience.
- Show that the issue is something that you have overcome or have learned to work with and that it does not affect your ability to perform in the new role.

"I don't think there is anything particular that I would mention. However, I would have loved it if we met more often. Due to covid, we all had to work remotely which made me miss the earlier work environment."

Traps to Avoid- Don't say anything negative. Just give a diplomatic answer.

Q23- Can you tell me about a time when you went above and beyond what was expected of you?

When an interviewer asks about a time when you went above and beyond what was expected of you, they want to understand your level of dedication, initiative and work ethic. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Give a specific example of a time when you exceeded expectations in your work.
- Explain the situation and the actions you took to go above and beyond.
- Highlight any relevant skills or experience that helped you achieve the result.
- Show the positive impact of your actions on the team, company or project.
- Emphasize your dedication, initiative, and work ethic.

Example: "In my last job, I was working on a project that was facing a tight deadline. I noticed that some of the team members were struggling to keep up with the pace, so I took the initiative to offer extra help and support.

I was training and mentoring them, and as a result, the team was projected on time and with higher quality than expected. This experience taught me the importance of initiative and leadership, and it showed me the positive impact that one person can have on a team. My dedication, initiative and work ethic were key factors in achieving this success."

Traps to Avoid- Don't give a vague example. Don't portray yourself to be lazy and self-centred.

Q24- How do you handle feedback, both positive and negative?

When an interviewer asks about how you handle feedback, both positive and negative, they want to understand your ability to receive and respond to constructive criticism and how you use feedback to improve your performance. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Show that you are open to receiving feedback and that you value it as an opportunity to improve.

- Explain how you respond to both positive and negative feedback, and how you use it to make changes to your work.
- Highlight any specific examples of how you have used feedback to improve your performance in the past.
- Emphasize your ability to take constructive criticism and learn from it.
- Show that you can separate personal feelings from professional feedback and that you can use it to grow and improve.

Example: "I believe that feedback is an essential part of personal and professional growth. I take both positive and negative feedback in stride, and I use it to improve my performance. When I receive positive feedback, I feel encouraged and motivated to continue doing well. When I receive negative feedback, I try to understand the reasoning behind it and use it as an opportunity to learn and grow. For example, I was once given feedback that my presentation skills needed improvement. I took that feedback to heart and I practised and improved my skills, I even got positive feedback on my next presentation. I believe that feedback is valuable, and I am always willing to take it, learn from it and improve."

Traps to Avoid- Do not portray yourself to be uncoachable. Do not show that you take things personally or only work with positive feedback.

Q25- What is your greatest professional achievement?

When an interviewer asks about your greatest professional achievement, they want to understand your level of success, your sense of pride and your level of ambition. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Give a specific example of an achievement that you are particularly proud of and that showcases your skills and experience.
- Explain the situation and the actions you took to achieve the result.
- Highlight any relevant skills or experience that helped you achieve the result.

- Show the positive impact of your achievement on the team, company or project.
- Emphasize your ambition, drive and sense of pride in the achievement.

Example: "One of my greatest professional achievements was when I successfully led a cross-functional team to increase sales by 15% within a year. I was able to achieve this by implementing a new sales strategy, which included identifying target markets and creating a detailed sales plan. I also provided extra training and support to the sales team, and as a result, they were able to achieve their targets and exceed expectations. This experience taught me the importance of leadership, strategy, and teamwork. I am proud of this achievement as it has had a positive impact on the company's growth and it has helped me to develop my skills and experience."

Traps to Avoid- Don't be self-centred. Don't sound arrogant.

Q26- Why were you fired?

When an interviewer asks why you were fired, they want to understand the circumstances surrounding your termination and if any red flags might indicate that you would be a poor fit for the new role. It's important, to be honest, and transparent in your answer, but also to frame it in a positive light and to take responsibility for your actions. Here are a few tips for answering this question:

- Be honest about the reason for your termination, but avoid going into too much detail or placing blame on others.
- Take responsibility for your actions and explain what you have learned from the experience.
- Show that you have taken steps to improve or address the issue that led to your termination.
- Emphasize your willingness to work hard and your commitment to being a valuable employee.

Example: "I was let go from my last job due to poor performance. I had been struggling to keep up with the workload and I was not meeting the expectations of my manager. I take full responsibility for my actions and I have learned a lot from this experience. Since then, I have taken steps to improve my time management and prioritize my tasks more effectively. I am now better equipped to handle high-pressure situations and I am confident that I can be a valuable employee in any workplace."

It's important to show that you have taken responsibility for your actions, learn from the experience and that you are now better equipped to handle similar situations in the future, emphasizing your willingness to work hard and your commitment to being a valuable employee.

Traps to Avoid- Do not point fingers at other people. Lack of accountability is repulsive. Do not go too much into detail. Be precise. This shows you have moved on and have no emotional baggage.

Q27- What type of work environment do you prefer?

- Be honest about your preferences, but also highlight that you are adaptable and can work in various environments.
- Emphasize your strengths and how they can be utilized in different settings.
- Highlight the importance of open communication and a strong team dynamic.
- Show how you are looking for a work environment that allows for personal and professional growth.

Example: "I believe that the key to finding the right work environment is to understand my strengths and how they can be utilized in different settings. I am adaptable and can work in various environments, but I prefer a fast-paced and challenging environment where I can continuously learn and grow. I also appreciate open communication and a strong team dynamic, as I believe that working collaboratively leads to more innovative and successful outcomes."

Traps to Avoid- talk about what you want instead of what you don't want. This keeps the frame of the conversation positive.

Q28- How would your boss and coworkers describe you?

- Highlight specific examples of your strengths and how they have been recognized by your boss and coworkers.
- Use specific adjectives that describe your work ethic and personality, such as "hardworking," "reliable," "collaborative," etc.
- Provide examples of how you have positively impacted the team or company.
- Mention any feedback or praise you have received from your boss or coworkers.

Example: "My boss and coworkers would describe me as a dedicated and hardworking individual. I am known for my reliability and ability to meet deadlines, as well as my strong work ethic. They would also say that I am a collaborative team player, who is always willing to go the extra mile to help out my colleagues. I have received positive feedback from my boss regarding my contributions to the team and how I have positively impacted the company. For example, I was recognized by my boss for my role in a successful project that helped increase the company's revenue by 15%. Overall, I am confident that my boss and coworkers would say that I am a valuable asset to the team and a pleasure to work with."

Traps to Avoid- Do not be self-deprecating. If you are a bad person. Do not tell the interviewer.

Q29- What motivates you?

- Be honest about what drives you to work hard and achieve your goals.
- Highlight how your motivators align with the company's mission and values.

- Provide specific examples of how your motivators have led to success in the past.
- Show how you continue to pursue personal and professional development to stay motivated.

Example: "I am motivated by the opportunity to make a positive impact and to continuously improve. I am driven by a desire to learn and grow, both personally and professionally, and to be part of a team that is working towards a common goal. I am always looking for opportunities to grow and make an impact, for example, I took on a leadership role in a project and was able to successfully implement new processes that resulted in a 20% increase in efficiency. I am always on the lookout for new opportunities to improve and make a difference and that is what motivates me."

Traps to Avoid- Do not sound like a hedonist. Never say you are motivated by money or sound desperate for any other factor.

Q30- How do you like to be managed?

- Highlight your preferred management style and how it aligns with your work style and goals.
- Emphasize your need for clear communication and feedback.
- Show how you prefer to be given autonomy and the ability to take ownership of your work.
- Mention any specific needs or preferences you have in terms of management.

Example: "I prefer a management style that allows me to take ownership of my work and provides me with autonomy to make decisions. I believe that clear communication and regular feedback are key to success, and I appreciate it when my manager takes the time to check in with me and provide guidance. I am a self-motivated individual who works best when given clear goals and expectations. I also like to have regular check-ins and updates with my manager, to make sure that I am on track and to address any concerns or issues. Overall, I prefer a management

style that provides me with the support and guidance I need to succeed while also giving me the autonomy to take ownership of my work."

Traps to Avoid- Do not be too picky. Do not sound like a difficult person to work with.

Q31- What other companies are you interviewing with?

- Be honest, but also express your enthusiasm for the position and company you are interviewing with.
- Avoid discussing any specific details or negative comments about other companies you are interviewing with.
- Mention that you are actively seeking new opportunities and that the company you are interviewing with is one of your top choices.
- Emphasize your interest in the position and the company's mission and values.

Example: "I am actively seeking new opportunities, and I am currently in the process of interviewing with a few other companies. However, I am very excited about this position and the opportunity to be a part of your team. The company's mission and values align with my personal and professional goals, and I am particularly impressed by the innovative projects and initiatives that the company is working on. I am eager to learn more about the role and how I can contribute to the company's success. I want to assure you that I am highly interested in this opportunity and I am giving my best effort in this interview process."

Traps to Avoid- Do not show a lack of interest in the role you are interviewing for.

Q32 - What good book have you read lately?

it's important to avoid pretending to have knowledge or interests that you don't have, as this can come across as inauthentic. Instead, it's recommended to have read a

few recent and influential books in your field and on management, as it shows that you are well-read and knowledgeable. However, it's important to make sure that the books you mention are of good quality and reflect positively on you. Additionally, mentioning a recent bestselling work of fiction by a well-known author can also make a positive impression.

Traps to Avoid- Do not mention a fairy tale. Do not lie.

Q33- How do you feel about reporting to a younger person?

- Show that you are open-minded and willing to work under any manager, regardless of their age.
- Emphasize your focus on results and the importance of a good working relationship, rather than age.
- Express your confidence in your ability to learn from and work well with a younger manager.
- Mention any previous experience reporting to a younger manager or working in a diverse age-group team, if any.

Example: "I am open-minded and willing to work under any manager, regardless of their age. I am results-driven, and my focus is on achieving the goals of the team and the company. I believe that a good working relationship is more important than age, and I am confident in my ability to learn from and work well with a younger manager. In my previous experience, I have had the opportunity to work with diverse age-group teams and I have always found it to be a positive and enlightening experience. I believe that a diverse team brings different perspectives and ideas to the table, and I always look forward to learning from my colleagues, regardless of their age."

Traps to avoid- Do not be rigid. Show yourself to be flexible and fair.

Q34- What would you do differently in your life if you could go back in time?

- Show that you have learned from your past experiences and have grown as a person.
- Highlight specific examples of things you would do differently, but also mention what you have learned from those experiences.
- Emphasize that you are always striving to improve and grow as a person.
- Avoid discussing any sensitive or negative information that may not be appropriate for a job interview setting.

Example: "Looking back, I have learned a lot from my past experiences and I have grown as a person. There are a few specific things that I would do differently, such as being more proactive in my professional development and networking. However, I have also learned the importance of being resilient and persevering through difficult times. I believe that it's important to always strive to improve and grow as a person, and I am constantly working on self-improvement. I am always learning from my past experiences and I am confident that I can apply those lessons to my future endeavours."

Traps to Avoid- avoid negative experiences, disappointments and negative answers that may hint at a lack of commitment to the job.

Q35- What do you like to do outside of work?

- Share hobbies or interests that showcase your personality and how you like to spend your free time.
- Highlight activities that demonstrate your leadership skills or creativity.
- Talk about activities or interests that align with the company's mission and values, if possible.
- Remember to keep your answer professional and appropriate for a job interview setting.

Example: "I enjoy staying active and engaged outside of work. Some of my hobbies include hiking, running, and playing soccer. I am also a voracious reader and enjoy reading books on history, biographies and self-improvement. I also like to volunteer and give back to my community, and I am an active member of a local charity that helps underprivileged children. I find that these activities not only help me to relax and unwind but also to develop new skills and perspectives, which I can bring back to my work. I believe that it's important to have balance in life and I try to achieve that by engaging in activities that I am passionate about."

Traps to Avoid- Do not be the person with no personality. Do not mention vague hobbies. Mention the ones that show character. Eg. consistently working out.

Q36- Could you have done better in your last job?

"It's always possible to find things that could've been done better with the benefit of hindsight, but I can't think of anything major that I would change in my last job."

Traps to Avoid- Do not mention anything negative or self-deprecating. This entire question is a trap. No confessions.

Q37- What makes you angry?

- Be honest about what triggers your anger, but also show that you have healthy coping mechanisms for dealing with it.
- Emphasize that you can maintain your professionalism and composure in the workplace, even when faced with difficult situations.
- Highlight your ability to resolve conflicts and confront difficult situations constructively.
- Avoid discussing any specific individuals or situations that may be sensitive or negative.

Example: "I am not easily angered, but I do get frustrated when I see situations of injustice, inefficiency or lack of integrity. I believe it's important to address these issues and find a constructive solution. I have learned to channel my emotions and approach conflicts calmly and professionally. I always try to see the other person's point of view and find a solution that benefits everyone. I can maintain my composure and professionalism in the face of difficult situations and I am confident that I can handle any situation that may arise positively."

Traps to Avoid- You are not Hulk. Show yourself to have control over your emotions.

Q38- Who has inspired you and why?

Share specific examples of individuals who have inspired you and explain why they have had an impact on you.

- Emphasize the qualities and characteristics that you admire in these individuals and how they align with your personal and professional goals.
- Show how these individuals have influenced your life and how their inspiration has helped shape you as a person.
- Avoid discussing any sensitive or negative information about the individuals you mention.

Examples- "There are many people who have inspired me throughout my life, but one person who stands out is my grandmother. She was a strong, independent woman who worked hard to provide for her family. She taught me the importance of determination and perseverance and the value of hard work. She also taught me to always be kind and compassionate towards others, no matter their circumstances. Her positive attitude, strong work ethic and ability to overcome difficult challenges have always been an inspiration to me. She taught me to always strive to be the best version of myself and to never give up on my dreams."

Traps to Avoid- Do not blabber. Do not give irrelevant examples. You should not mention your grade 10 teacher.

Q39- Why shouldn't I hire internally for this position instead of hiring you?

Example- "I can understand that it is beneficial to promote employees from within the company, as choosing someone from outside. It is important to ensure that the department is as strong as possible and I feel that I am the best candidate for the job because of my qualifications and experience....."

Traps to Avoid- This is an objection and hence a buying signal. Do not take this negatively. Focus on your value instead of trashing internal hiring.

What's Next?

"The greatest investment you can make is in yourself."

- Warren Buffett

Congratulations! You are in the top 20% of people who are reading this chapter. Most people never finish the books they buy.

This book contains everything you need to succeed but if you feel like you need my or Bani's personalized help, check out our [CAREER COACHING](#).

Would you be opposed to getting a job faster? If not...

I help with all 3 parts of the career. If you remember it from the introduction - Product, Marketing and Sales.

As of Dec 2023, we have helped immigrants get offers worth \$6.9 Million. Why is our career coaching so effective?

Let's play a quick game!

I want you to imagine 2 flowers. One is a flower in a pot and the other one is a cut flower in a vase. Which one would last longer?

A) Flower in a pot

B) Cut flower in a vase



Flower in a pot



Flower in a vase

Obviously the one in the pot, right? The reason is that it has roots, nutrients and it's in the soil. The other one is cut, all on its own, with just water.

[Details on a payment plan towards the end!]

It's kind of like your dream job hunt journey. If you're on your own, a cut flower in a vase, you don't have anything to hold onto. You don't have any system to hold onto. You don't have someone to hold you accountable.

You're all on your own, so your job hunt journey is highly likely to last a very short amount of time before it dies down because of frustration and hopelessness.

However, if you have roots to hold onto, if you have a coach that can get you through it, someone that can help you perfect your resume, guide you on the right job strategy, and help you nail your interview, etc., someone who can remind you of your goal, and hold you accountable, provide you with a community to refer you for jobs, your journey would not only end at your dream job but will also be a lot more faster.

Let me explain with an example:

Shishir came to Canada to pursue his Bachelor's. He was a bright kid and made it a point to gain on campus work experience during his undergrad. He graduated in April and was applying to 100s of applications every month. He was determined to get his field job, so he kept applying and used to tailor his resume and customize his cover letter for each and every job application.

Even after working so hard, he was not getting any interview call. He was like a cut flower in a vase without water. 4 months into the job search, he was tired, frustrated and helpless. His confidence took a big hit. That is when he came to us for career coaching. He wanted a support system. He wanted someone to guide him to work hard but in the direction that would actually get him the results.

Similar to a flower getting nutrients from the pot, joining the coaching provided him the support he needed. He got guidance on choosing the right role, revamping his resume to make his on-campus experience look impactful, and getting more confident going into interviews. As soon as we worked on his application, he went from getting no interviews for 4 months to getting several interview calls!

Result: He got his dream job, nearly doubled his salary and even confidently negotiated \$5K!

So, if you are stuck, it's not your mistake. The education system here does not provide us with the right guidance to get a field job. It lets you be a cut flower in a vase. However, once you get a coach, you get an entire support system like a flower in a pot.

If you are among the few who value time over money, check out our [CAREER COACHING](#).